



Unstoppable force: Alex Pereira's (left) fight against Khalil Rountree Jr. at UFC 307 in Utah exceeded everyone's expectations. PICS: GETTY IMAGES

ROUNTREE NO MATCH FOR POATAN POWER

The reigning champion showed why he is **among the best** in the business.

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Alex 'Poatan' Pereira has silenced his doubters once again, for the third time this year. The 37-year-old defended the light heavyweight title thrice in just 175 days, breaking the previous record held by UFC icon Ronda Rousey.

His fight against Khalil Rountree Jr. at UFC 307 in Utah exceeded everyone's expectations. The fact that Poatan is the reigning champion and

the second-best pound-for-pound fighter would send shivers down the spine of anyone facing him.

But Rountree Jr. was different.

The roughly four-and-a-half-minute stint inside the octagon was perhaps the longest and toughest period Pereira had experienced in a long while.

Rountree Jr. marginally overpowered Pereira in the first two rounds with impactful blows through hooks and jabs. However, as the fight wore on, the champion's slow and steady approach began to pay off.

Pereira capitalised on every

opening and gained the upper hand over his opponent. The towering Brazilian began to punish the Las Vegas native, breaking him down, busting him up, and finishing him along the fence.

His dominance culminated in a knockout in the dying moments of the fourth round, as Pereira walked away with yet another win.

A controversial comeback

In the co-main event, Julianna Peña became a two-time UFC women's bantamweight champion, edging out Raquel Pennington in a